

NovaHR

Company Policy Notebook

AI-Powered HR Assistant Platform

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This notebook contains all official company policies for NovaHR. Every employee is expected to read, understand, and comply with the guidelines described in this document. These policies ensure a safe, fair, and productive work environment for everyone.

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■ Policy 01 **Code of Conduct**

Every NovaHR employee is expected to maintain the highest standards of professional conduct at all times — inside the office, on client premises, and in any digital communication representing the company.

Acceptable Behaviour

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and visitors with dignity and respect.
- Communicate honestly and transparently in all professional matters.
- Maintain punctuality and honour commitments.
- Take ownership of your work and deliver quality results.
- Report any violations or concerns to your manager or HR immediately.

Unacceptable Behaviour

- Harassment, bullying, or intimidation of any kind.
- Dishonesty, fraud, or misrepresentation of facts.
- Theft or misuse of company property or resources.
- Use of abusive language or disrespectful behaviour.
- Sharing confidential company information with unauthorised parties.

Note: Violations of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

■ Policy 02 **Attendance & Working Hours**

Regular attendance and punctuality are essential for team productivity and smooth business operations. All employees are required to adhere to the standard working schedule unless a formal exception has been approved.

Standard Working Hours

- Office hours: 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, Monday to Friday.
- Lunch break: 1:00 PM to 2:00 PM (1 hour).
- Total working hours: 8 hours per day, 40 hours per week.
- Saturday and Sunday are official days off.

Late Arrival Policy

- Arriving after 9:15 AM is considered late.
- Three late arrivals in a month will result in one casual leave being deducted.
- Habitual late-coming may lead to formal disciplinary action.

Work From Home (WFH) Policy

- WFH requires prior written approval from your direct manager.
- Employees must be reachable and responsive during office hours while working from home.
- WFH is not a substitute for leave and will not be approved during critical project phases.

Note: Attendance records are maintained digitally and reviewed monthly by HR.

■ Policy 03 **Salary & Compensation**

NovaHR is committed to providing fair, competitive, and transparent compensation to all employees. Salaries are determined based on role, experience, skills, and market benchmarks.

Salary Structure

- Salaries are paid on the last working day of every month.
- Salary is credited directly to the employee's registered bank account.
- Salary slips are generated and shared digitally by the 1st of the following month.
- Any salary discrepancy must be reported to HR within 5 working days.

Bonuses & Incentives

- Annual performance bonus is awarded based on yearly appraisal results.
- Project completion bonuses may be given at management's discretion.
- Festival bonuses (Diwali, etc.) are provided as per company policy each year.
- Referral bonuses are applicable as per the active referral programme.

Deductions

- TDS (Tax Deducted at Source) is applied as per applicable government tax slabs.
- Leave Without Pay (LWP) will be deducted for unapproved absences.
- Provident Fund (PF) deductions are applied as per statutory requirements.

Note: Salary details are strictly confidential. Sharing your salary with colleagues is discouraged.

NovaHR recognises the importance of work-life balance. The following leave entitlements are provided to all full-time employees per calendar year.

Leave Type	Days Per Year	Carry Forward
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days	No
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days	No
Earned Leave (EL)	15 days	Yes (up to 30 days)
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	N/A
Paternity Leave	5 days	No
Public Holidays	12 days	N/A

How to Apply for Leave

- Submit leave request via the NovaHR system at least 2 days in advance.
- For sick leave, inform your manager on the same morning via message or email.
- Medical certificate required for sick leave exceeding 3 consecutive days.
- Leave approval is subject to team availability and manager discretion.
- Unapproved leaves will be treated as Loss of Pay (LOP).

Note: Leave balances are visible in real-time through the NovaHR assistant.

The safety and security of every employee is a top priority at NovaHR. All employees must follow safety protocols and immediately report any hazardous situation or security concern to the facilities team or HR.

General Safety Rules

- Keep your workstation and common areas clean and hazard-free.
- Do not tamper with electrical equipment or safety installations.
- All visitors must be registered at reception and escorted at all times.
- Emergency exits must be kept clear and unobstructed at all times.

Emergency Procedures

- In case of fire: activate the nearest alarm, evacuate calmly via emergency exits.
- Assembly point is located at the main parking area outside the building.
- Do not use elevators during fire or earthquake emergencies.
- Emergency contact numbers are posted at all key locations in the office.

Data Security Guidelines

- Never share your login credentials with anyone, including colleagues.
- Lock your computer screen whenever you step away from your desk.
- Do not transfer company data to personal devices or external storage.
- Immediately report any suspected data breach or phishing attempt to IT.

Note: NovaHR uses AI-powered monitoring to detect and alert on unusual data access patterns.

■ Policy 06 IT & Internet Usage Policy

Company-provided IT equipment and internet access are for professional use. Responsible and ethical use of all technology resources is expected from every employee at all times.

Acceptable Use

- Use company laptops, software, and internet for work-related purposes.
- Keep all software and systems updated as directed by the IT team.
- Use only company-approved communication tools for official discussions.
- Store work files on company-approved cloud storage or local servers only.

Prohibited Activities

- Downloading pirated software, movies, or any illegal content.
- Accessing inappropriate, offensive, or non-work-related websites.
- Installing unauthorised software on company devices.
- Using company email for personal business or chain messages.
- Attempting to bypass firewalls, network restrictions, or security systems.

Device Policy

- Company laptops must not be taken outside the office without approval.
- Lost or stolen devices must be reported to IT and HR within 1 hour.
- Personal mobile phones should be on silent mode during meetings.
- Company devices must be returned in good condition upon exit.

Note: Internet usage is monitored for security purposes. Employees have no expectation of privacy on company networks.

■ Policy 07 **Anti-Harassment & Equal Opportunity**

NovaHR is committed to providing a workplace free from discrimination, harassment, and bias of any kind. Every employee deserves to work in an environment where they feel safe, respected, and valued.

Zero Tolerance Policy

- Harassment based on gender, caste, religion, age, disability, or sexual orientation is strictly prohibited.
- Any form of bullying, intimidation, verbal abuse, or threatening behaviour will not be tolerated.
- Sexual harassment in any form — verbal, physical, or digital — is a serious offence.
- Retaliation against anyone who reports harassment is also strictly prohibited.

Equal Opportunity Employment

- All hiring, promotion, and appraisal decisions are based solely on merit and performance.
- NovaHR actively promotes diversity and inclusion at all levels of the organisation.
- Equal pay is ensured for equal work regardless of gender or background.

Reporting & Redressal

- Complaints can be submitted to HR directly or via the anonymous reporting portal.
- All complaints will be investigated confidentially within 10 working days.
- If found guilty, disciplinary action up to termination will be taken.
- An Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) is in place as per the POSH Act 2013.

Note: All complaints are handled with strict confidentiality. The identity of the complainant is protected.

■ Policy 08 Performance & Appraisal Policy

NovaHR believes in recognising and rewarding excellence. The performance appraisal process is designed to be transparent, fair, and growth-oriented — helping employees understand their strengths and areas of improvement.

Appraisal Cycle

- Formal appraisals are conducted annually every April.
- Mid-year reviews are held in October for goal tracking and feedback.
- New employees are evaluated after completing their probation period (3 months).
- Performance is rated on a 5-point scale: Exceptional, Exceeds, Meets, Below, Unsatisfactory.

Evaluation Criteria

- Quality and quantity of work delivered.
- Adherence to deadlines and project timelines.
- Teamwork, collaboration, and communication skills.
- Initiative, innovation, and problem-solving ability.
- Attendance, punctuality, and professional conduct.

Promotions & Increments

- Promotions are based on consistent high performance over at least 1 year.
- Salary increments are awarded annually based on appraisal ratings.
- Fast-track promotions may be awarded for exceptional contributions.
- All promotion decisions are approved by department head and HR.

Note: Employees can request a feedback session with their manager at any time through the NovaHR system.

■ Policy 09 Confidentiality Policy

Employees of NovaHR are entrusted with access to sensitive business information. Protecting this information is not just a policy obligation — it is a fundamental responsibility of every team member.

What is Confidential Information

- Client names, contact details, project information, and business contracts.
- Company financial data, pricing strategies, and revenue figures.
- Proprietary software code, algorithms, and technical architecture.
- Employee salary information, personal data, and HR records.
- Business strategies, product roadmaps, and partnership details.

Employee Obligations

- Do not share confidential information with anyone outside the company without written authorisation.
- Do not discuss sensitive matters in public places or on unsecured channels.
- Confidentiality obligations continue even after leaving the company.
- All employees are required to sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) on joining.

Consequences of Breach

- Immediate termination of employment.
- Legal action under applicable laws including the IT Act and IPC.
- Financial liability for damages caused by the breach.

Note: If you are unsure whether something is confidential, always check with your manager before sharing.

■ Policy 10 **Exit / Resignation Policy**

NovaHR ensures a respectful and smooth exit process for all departing employees. A proper offboarding process protects both the employee and the company's interests.

Resignation Process

- Submit a formal written resignation letter to your manager and HR.
- Clearly state your last working day based on the applicable notice period.
- Resignation must be submitted via official company email.
- Verbal resignations are not accepted as official notice.

Notice Period

- Probation employees: 2 weeks notice period.
- Confirmed employees (under 1 year): 1 month notice period.
- Confirmed employees (1 year and above): 2 months notice period.
- Notice period buyout is possible with mutual agreement and HR approval.

Exit Formalities & Final Settlement

- Return all company assets: laptop, ID card, access cards, and documents.
- Complete knowledge transfer and handover as directed by your manager.
- Clear all outstanding dues, advances, and pending items.
- Full and final settlement will be processed within 30 days of last working day.
- Experience letter and relieving letter will be issued after completing exit formalities.
- PF and gratuity will be processed as per applicable statutory regulations.

Note: Exit interviews are conducted by HR to collect feedback and improve the employee experience.

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